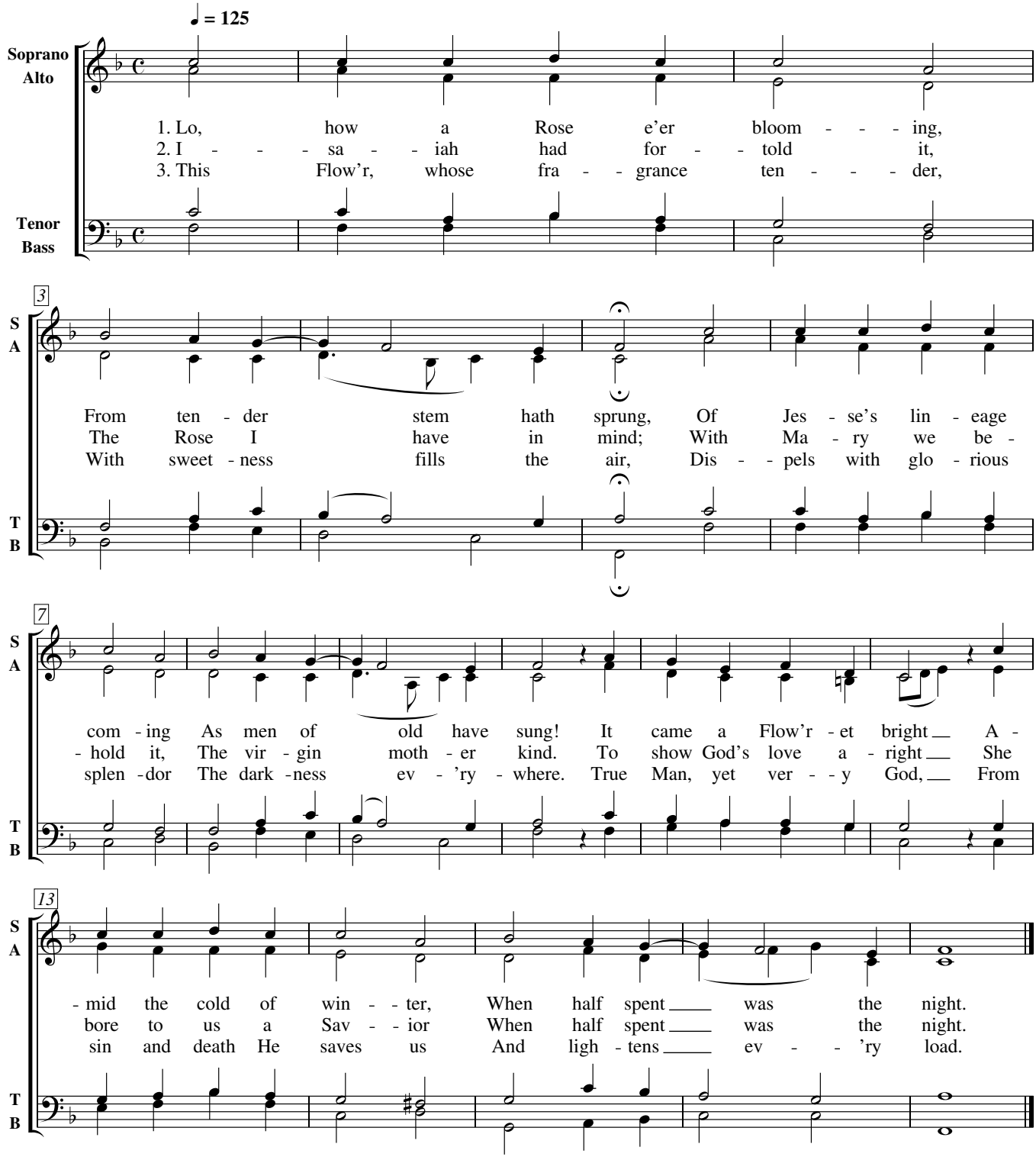
Lo, How a Rose E’er Blooming

Setting by Michael Praetorius, 1609 (Cologne, 1599)

Drumming: 4 beat lead in; then no drum

1. Lo, how a Rose e'er blooming,
From tender stem hath sprung,
Of Jesse's lineage coming
As men of old have sung!
It came a Flow'ret bright
Amid the cold of winter,
When half spent was the night.

2. Isaiah had fortold it,
The Rose I have in mind;
With Mary we behold it,
The virgin mother kind.
To show God's love aright
She bore to us a Savior
When half spent was the night.

3. This Flow'r, whose fragrance tender,
With sweetness fills the air,
Dispels with glorious splendor
The darkness ev'rywhere.
True Man, yet very God,
From sin and death He saves us
And lightens ev'ry load.